Such criticisms of the convention are indicative of many of the unresolved problems which lay between Britain and Russia in the early twentieth century. Attitudes and opinions do not alter as easily as treaties are written, and the 1907 agreement did not put to rest Anglo-Russian rivalry. British suspicion of Russian intentions in Asia certainly continued long after 1907. Minto epitomised official scepticism when he argued that Britain would 'gain nothing [from the convention] except a mere phantom of friendship with a Power who will not cease secretly to advance her own interests, regardless of any pledges she may give'.[41] The idea that Russia could not be trusted in its promises was a long-standing feature of Russophobia, which the agreement did little to change. As Lord Hardinge explained when he replaced Minto in 1910: 'In India prejudices die hard, and nowhere so hard as amongst old soldiers who for two generations have been taught to regard Russia as a dangerous enemy.'[42] This distrust was amply demonstrated, for example, during the negotiations over the Trans-Persian Railway. In order to counter Germany's Baghdad railway, and to secure its commercial relations, Russia proposed building a railway through Persia, ultimately connecting with the India network. For Britain, however, the project posed a myriad of problems. While it did not want to alienate Russia by an outright refusal to take part in the scheme, it was highly wary of India's security, and building a railway that would allow the quick transportation of Russian troops through Britain's 'buffer state' was not a scheme it wanted to encourage. This is one example of how, despite the Anglo-Russian Convention, Britain still distrusted Russia. The Russians too, found it difficult to move on from old patterns of behaviour and many veteran Russian diplomats continued to cause problems in Persia after 1907.[43] The Russian minister in Tehran, N.G. Hartwig, for example, 'was one of those who considered at the time of the signature of the Convention, that his country was being deprived of the ripe fruit which was ready to fall into her lap'.[44]

While the convention did not fundamentally alter Anglo-Russian relations, however, it did have important consequences for Britain's relationship with South Asia. For one thing, it served to inadvertently encourage Afghan nationalism. That the emir had not even been consulted about the agreement hurt Afghan pride. (Minto had warned as much, but when he suggested making the negotiations for the convention known to the emir, he had been